Were the July power cuts predictable?

The Malta Chamber's statement, tested against NSO and Eurostat data

THE CLAIM

"It is evident that the investment carried out was not enough."

Malta Chamber of Commerce, Enterprise and Industry, 21 July 2026

A statement on the July 2026 cuts; it gives no figures.

Quotes read through a web reader; the NAO review was not opened (second-hand).

VERDICT

NOT SUBSTANTIATED

Rise foreseeable; 'enough' has no yardstick.

SUPPORTED | LARGELY SUPPORTED | **NOT SUBSTANTIATED** | MISLEADING | CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

+42.6%

Peak demand 2018–23

465 to 663 MW (NSO). Residents plus tourists grew 13.4%.

31%

Explained by people

Population and tourists account for about a third of the rise in the peak.

631 MW

The trend foresaw it

A line fitted to 2017–2022 gives 631 MW for 2025; the actual peak was 637 MW.

?

Enough investment?

No figure for what was invested or needed; the audit review was seen second-hand.

FAIR TO SAY

This check covers demand and investment, not who caused the July 2026 faults.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

- ☐ The Chamber's figures on investment.
- ☐ The National Audit Office review in full.
- ☐ Enemalta's load forecast and capital spending.